

Tran Zha

Software Engineering Manager | Platform Modernisation | Technical Leadership

Brisbane, QLD | Full Australian working rights | Australian permanent resident

tranzha83@gmail.com | +61 402 798 180 | <https://www.linkedin.com/in/tranzha> | <https://github.com/trannzfsg> | <https://trannzfsg.github.io/resume>

Professional Summary

Engineering Manager and hands-on software engineering leader with 15+ years of experience building software products, leading teams and modernising complex platforms. I help teams make sense of messy legacy systems, turn unclear problems into practical delivery plans, and keep business-critical work moving without losing sight of quality. My leadership style mirrors effective LLM engineering: clear intent, enough context, practical guardrails, measurable success and tight feedback loops. I use LLM tools in work and personal projects to speed up research, prototyping, documentation and analysis, while keeping human review and engineering judgement at the centre.

Key Skills

- **Software engineering leadership:** Engineering Manager, Software Engineering Manager, Engineering Lead, Technical Lead, people leadership, team coaching, hiring support, career development, performance conversations and 1:1 feedback.
 - **Delivery and stakeholder management:** Agile delivery, software delivery lifecycle, SDLC, roadmap planning, delivery ownership, scope and debt tradeoffs, executive communication, vendor management and cross team dependency management.
 - **Platform modernisation and architecture:** Strangler Fig migration, monolith decomposition, service boundaries, backward compatibility, REST APIs, CQRS, event driven architecture, gRPC, clean architecture, Vertical Slice Architecture and domain modelling.
 - **Cloud, DevOps and data:** AWS, GCP, Kubernetes, EKS, Docker, GitHub Actions, Octopus, OpenTelemetry, observability, incident response, service reliability, SQL Server, PostgreSQL, Snowflake, BigQuery and data migration.
 - **Hands-on engineering toolkit:** C# and .NET, REST APIs, SQL, React, Node.js, Next.js, Firebase, Supabase, Flutter, DevOps automation and AI-assisted prototyping.
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Leadership & AI-Aware Delivery Strengths

- **Prompt engineering / clear communication:** Turns blurry requests into explicit intent, tradeoffs, decisions and next steps so teams and stakeholders know what is actually being asked.
- **Context engineering / shared why:** Gives teams the background, constraints and business reasoning behind work, so implementation choices fit the problem instead of only the ticket.
- **Harness engineering / delivery guardrails:** Defines goals, boundaries, operating agreements and measurable success criteria, making "good" concrete and reducing tangents.
- **Loop engineering / autonomous improvement:** Sets clear goals, then drives build, test, verify, deploy and feedback loops so teams can make local decisions without micromanagement.

Professional Experience

Engineering Manager, MyCRM Replatforming | Loan Market Group

Feb 2023 to Present

Selected initiative: Contact Replatform, centralising contact mutation and retrieval

- Leading the highest-complexity MyCRM replatform initiative: contacts are entangled across more than half of the monolith's business logic, with historical edge cases and patches spread across screens, workflows and services.
- Building Contact v2 with backward compatibility and future-facing architecture, while untangling fragmented product logic into centralised mutation and retrieval paths and clearer ownership and authorisation boundaries.
- Using a Strangler Fig approach: facade over the existing data store first, gradual migration of legacy consumers, then replacement of the underlying data model once behaviours are controlled.
- Positioning Contact as a reference architecture for future MyCRM work, applying CQRS, domain and integration events, gRPC internal communication, clean architecture, Vertical Slice Architecture and stronger service boundaries.
- Partnering with product, architecture and frontend teams to introduce a new Material UI-based design system while preserving legacy interoperability during migration.

Selected initiative: Diversified Deals Replatform, generic engagement model for financial deals

- Led replatforming of residential-focused deal capability into a generic Engagement model that can handle multiple product types to support business growth.
- Used the Engagement platform to launch asset finance, commercial and insurance deal journeys, expanding MyCRM beyond residential lending without duplicating core deal logic.
- Drove domain modelling, transition planning, roadmap alignment and stakeholder tradeoffs across product, engineering and business groups.
- Reset expectations and delivery discipline in a struggling team, improving clarity, technical direction and execution focus across a long-running replatform program.

Engineering Manager, Commission System, Business Insights and Podium Data Migration | Loan Market Group

Mar 2021 to Apr 2023

- Built and led teams across commissions, reporting and analytics and acquisition migration programs; shaped business cases, roadmaps, discovery and delivery plans for complex domains.
- Evaluated Snowflake, Starburst, ThoughtSpot, BigQuery, Sisense and related platforms; separated data lake and warehouse concerns and delivered ingestion, transformation and reporting pipelines.
- Led migration work after acquisitions, including one-off and overnight delta pipelines using SSIS, TaskFactory, Salesforce, Kubernetes jobs and AWS services; supported onshore growth from ~10 to 30+ engineers.

Engineering Manager, MyCRM Platform Modernisation | Loan Market Group

Jul 2019 to Apr 2021

- Introduced OpenTelemetry, contextual logging, GitHub Actions and Octopus, improved local development workflows, and led containerisation and Kubernetes/EKS migrations.

Senior DevOps Engineer and Senior Engineer, MyCRM Launch and Cloud Modernisation | New Zealand Financial Services Group

Apr 2016 to Jun 2019

- Helped rebuild, launch and modernise MyCRM across Australia and New Zealand; migrated from on-premises to AWS, CI/CD and improved observability; coordinated security audit activity.
- Supported offshore expansion from 0 to 30+ engineers and QA staff; team mentoring and culture building; Scrum master for multiple teams.
- Managed cloud spend, software licensing and vendor cost inputs for the MyCRM platform, balancing operational needs with budget and delivery priorities.
- Supported production operations, incident response and service reliability for business-critical CRM systems, using monitoring and support feedback to drive continuous improvement.

Software Engineer | LifeDirect / Inform Holdings / Trade Me

Jul 2008 to Mar 2016

- Full-stack engineering across online insurance, internal admin, reporting, CRM and hosting operations; built quoting, application and underwriting workflows and mentored team members as the function grew.

Hands-On AI and LLM-Assisted Personal Projects

- **mqcyb.tranzha.com - Math Quiz / mqcyb:** Flutter learning app previously released on the App Store; used AI assistance for rapid feature iteration, UI refinement and content generation support.
- **transtags.tranzha.com - Bank transaction categorisation and tax returns:** React and Node.js product experiment for importing bank transactions, categorising spending and preparing tax return exports; explored Supabase before pausing the project.
- **sports.tranzha.com - Community sports registration and mini CRM:** Next.js, Node.js and Firebase app for registrations, participants and lightweight community operations management.
- **Roblox Autorun Obby:** Roblox game/prototype using AI-assisted scripting, level iteration and gameplay experimentation.

Education, Selected Coursework & Languages

Postgraduate Diploma in Science, Computer Science - University of Auckland | Bachelor of Science, Computer Science - University of Auckland | Bachelor of Commerce, Finance and Economics - University of Auckland

Selected coursework: AWS Solutions Architect Associate coursework (A Cloud Guru); Kubernetes Administrator coursework (Udemy); Machine Learning and Deep Learning coursework (Coursera/deeplearning.ai); Scrum Master training

Languages: English, Mandarin.